

The Occupy Wall Streeters attack the government from the left. The Tea Partiers launch their assault from the right. The central authority may not hold.

But things are coming apart for a reason. Centralized control no longer works. Expanding credit no longer produces expanding output. Further government “investment” no longer produces decent returns. The whole edifice wobbles—and then collapses.

And people are better off. Belgium, which has been coming apart for years, still has one of the highest growth rates in Europe.

Since modern nations can’t really afford the lifestyle goals they have set for themselves, they must cut back. That will mean that the people who counted on national health programs, free education, unemployment, welfare, pensions, and the other services provided by the government will be disappointed. They will look for alternatives.

And the alternative they will find is the one that was there all along—the one that has been the most reliable, from long before any histories were ever written up to the present: the family.

Unable to depend on the government when times are tough? Who ya gonna call? A federal bureaucrat? Or a friendly uncle?

To whom will you pledge allegiance? To the nation-state that let you down? Or the family that holds you up?

“NOBODY REALLY STARTS WITH NOTHING”

A study conducted in the early 1990s found that of those who inherited around \$150,000, 20 percent left the labor force within three years.³ This phenomenon has been confirmed by more recent research.

In *The Millionaire Next Door*, Thomas Stanley and William Danko found that children who had received family money were worth four-fifths less than those in the same professions who did not receive money from their parents.⁴